

Slides 2.2: Traits, Strengths, and Interests

Slide outline for Lesson 2.2, two days. Day 1 is slides 1 to 10 (strengths and notice cards). Day 2 is slides 11 to 21 (the interest quiz and careers).

Day 1

Slide 1: Traits, Strengths, and Interests

- Lesson 2.2, Day 1: what you do well
- Unit 2: Me, My Goals, My Money
- Today: your own list, and three people's lists about you Image: three small cards face down on a table, one labeled "To: you." Notes: Leave this up while students enter. Same tables of four as Lesson 2.1.

Slide 2: Do now

- Write one thing you are good at
- Write one time you did it
- Two sentences, two minutes Notes: Cold call four. Count the answers that name a school subject versus an action. Then the hook: by the end of today, three people at your table will each tell you something you are good at, and some of it you do not know yet.

Slide 3: Three words

- Trait: how you usually are (quiet, outgoing, patient, stubborn)
- Strength: something you do well (fixes bikes, calms down a crying kid)
- Interest: something you want to do more of (drawing, basketball, cooking)
- A trait can turn into a strength: patient becomes "sits with my cousin until she gets the math" Notes: Students copy the three definitions onto the handout header.

Slide 4: Which is it?

- One finger: trait. Two fingers: strength. Three fingers: interest
- I am usually quiet in a new group
- I can take apart a bike and put it back together
- I want to learn to make sushi
- I am stubborn
- I remember everyone's birthday
- I like drawing on everything Notes: Answers: trait, strength, interest, trait, strength, interest. Six more on the next slide. Cut to six total if time is short.

Slide 5: Which is it? (continued)

- I am patient

- I calmed my little brother down when he got lost at the mall
- I want to run my own business
- I talk a lot
- I get a group to agree on a plan
- I like taking care of animals Notes: Answers: trait, strength, interest, trait, strength, interest (accept strength for the last one with a reason). Settle the arguable ones: the difference is whether it names something done.

Slide 6: The strengths inventory

- 24 strengths in four families: Thinking, Doing, People, Character
- For each one: yes often, sometimes, or not yet
- “Not yet” is not an insult. It is a to-do list
- Then star your top three and write evidence: one time it happened
- 10 minutes Notes: Circulate. Push feelings toward events. “I am good at fixing things” becomes “I fixed the chain on my brother’s bike without a video.”

Slide 7: Notice cards, the rule

- You write one card for each of the three other people at your table
- A card names something the person did, not something they are
- “You are nice” does not count
- “I noticed you are good at explaining because you re-explained the recipe to me on lab day” counts
- Sign it, so they can ask you about it Image: one filled-in notice card, the sentence frame visible: I noticed you are good at ___ because I saw you ___. Notes: Read a sample from each table before cards are handed over. Send back any card with only an adjective.

Slide 8: Hand them over

- Face down
- Nobody reads theirs until I say go
- On go: read your three cards
- Copy the one that surprised you most into Part 2 Notes: Watch the quiet student at each table. If a pile looks thin, drop in a card of your own; you have watched this student work for 37 days.

Slide 9: Debrief

- Whose card named a strength you did not put in your own top three?
- Why do other people see strengths we miss?
- Today was what you do well. Tomorrow is what you like doing. They are not always the same, and that is fine Notes: Take four. Keep it short; the exit line is next.

Slide 10: Exit line

- A strength I put in my top three: ____
- A strength someone else saw in me: ____

- Are they the same? Yes or no
- Keep your three cards. You need them on day 39 Notes: Three students read theirs. Collect handouts and cards together. Tomorrow: the interest quiz.

Day 2

Slide 11: Traits, Strengths, and Interests

- Lesson 2.2, Day 2: what you like doing
- Today: a 30-question quiz, six letters, and two careers to explore Image: six small icons in a row: a wrench, a magnifying glass, a paintbrush, two people, a megaphone, a checklist. Notes: Quiz at every seat, face down. Lesson 2.1 sort sheets out of the FACS folder.

Slide 12: Do now

- A bike. Would you rather: fix it, figure out why it broke, paint it, teach someone to ride it, sell it, or keep the records of who rented it?
- Pick one. Write why. One sentence Notes: Show of hands per choice. Say: you just took the first question of the quiz. There are six ways to like a bike. The six choices map to R, I, A, S, E, C in that order; this is also the tie breaker.

Slide 13: The six types

- R, Realistic: hands, tools, machines, outside (wrench)
- I, Investigative: figure it out, science, puzzles (magnifying glass)
- A, Artistic: make new things, your own style (paintbrush)
- S, Social: help, teach, take care of people (two people)
- E, Enterprising: lead, persuade, sell, compete (megaphone)
- C, Conventional: order, records, numbers, careful (checklist) Notes: Students write one word next to each letter on the quiz header. Say what the quiz is: a paper version in the same six categories counselors use. Say what it is not: a fortune. If they have used the O*NET Interest Profiler, say the letters are the same. *[Sal: check with the counselor whether grade 8 takes it.]*

Slide 14: The rule

- Answer for the you of today
- Not the you that would look good
- Not your friend
- There are no wrong answers and no bad letters
- 30 items, yes or no, 12 minutes Notes: Read the first three items aloud to set the pace. Then no help on what an item “really means.” The student decides.

Slide 15: Score it

- Count your yeses for each row of numbers
- Highest count: first letter. Second highest: second letter

- Tie? Use your bike answer
- Grade 6: items 1 to 18, count the first three numbers in each row Notes: Spot check three grids per table for arithmetic. A wrong count changes the letters.

Slide 16: Read your two paragraphs

- Find your two letters in the Part 3 table
- Does the paragraph fit? Circle
- One word in it that sounds like you, one that does not Notes: The “does not” word matters. Nobody is all of one type.

Slide 17: Careers for your letters

- Pick two careers from the lists (one can come from a third letter)
- For each: one sentence that names a strength from yesterday or an interest from today
- “Chef, because I like food” is not enough
- “Chef, because I cook dinner two nights a week without help, and I said yes to 1, 7, and 25” is Notes: Read one career sentence per table. Ask “which strength?” if it names none.

Slide 18: Values check

- Open your Lesson 2.1 sort sheet
- Would career 1 let you keep your top three values?
- Which value might it fight, and why? Notes: This is the first time the three sheets (values, strengths, interests) meet. They meet again on the one-pager.

Slide 19: The 16 career clusters (grade 8 stretch)

- Agriculture, Food, and Natural Resources; Architecture and Construction; Arts, A/V Technology, and Communications; Business Management and Administration
- Education and Training; Finance; Government and Public Administration; Health Science
- Hospitality and Tourism; Human Services; Information Technology; Law, Public Safety, Corrections, and Security
- Manufacturing; Marketing; Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics; Transportation, Distribution, and Logistics Notes: Grade 8 writes the cluster for each of their two careers and the education it needs. Everyone else sees this list again in Lesson 2.21.

Slide 20: Whip around

- Your two letters and one career, five words or fewer
- I tally the letters on the board
- Which letter is biggest in this room? Smallest?
- What jobs would this room be short on? Notes: Keep the tally. Compare it with the cluster choices in Lesson 2.21.

Slide 21: Exit card and tomorrow

- My two letters, two careers to explore, one thing I want to know about one of them
- Tomorrow: the All About Me one-pager. Bring your three sheets and your three notice cards
- Optional: ask an adult who works what their two letters would be Notes: Collect. Sort into “got it” (two letters, two careers with reasons) and “needs more.” The “needs more” pile gets a two-minute conference at the start of Lesson 2.3.